

Sachin Ramesh Tendulkar (/ˌsʌtʃɪn tɛnˈduːlkər/ [ⓘ]; Marathi: [sətʃɪn tɛɳdulkər]; born 24 April 1973) is an Indian former international [cricketer](#) who [captained the Indian national team](#). Often dubbed the "**God of Cricket**" in India, he is widely regarded as one of the greatest cricketers of all time.^[5] He holds several world records, including being the all-time highest [run-scorer](#) in international cricket,^[6] receiving the most [player of the match](#) awards in international cricket,^[7] and being the only batsman to score 100 international centuries.^[8] Tendulkar was a [Member of Parliament, Rajya Sabha](#) by [presidential nomination](#) from 2012 to 2018.^{[9][10]}

Tendulkar took up cricket at the age of eleven, made his Test match debut on 15 November 1989 against [Pakistan](#) in [Karachi](#) at the age of sixteen, and went on to represent [Mumbai](#) domestically and [India](#) internationally for over 24 years.^[11] In 2002, halfway through his career, [Wisden](#) ranked him the second-greatest Test batsman of all time, behind [Don Bradman](#), and the second-greatest ODI batsman of all time, behind [Viv Richards](#).^[12] The same year, Tendulkar was a part of the team that was one of the joint-winners of the [2002 ICC Champions Trophy](#). Later in his career, Tendulkar was part of the Indian team that won the [2011 Cricket World Cup](#), his first win in six [World Cup](#) appearances for India.^[13] He had previously been named "Player of the Tournament" at the [2003 World Cup](#).

Tendulkar has received several awards from the [government of India](#): the [Arjuna Award](#) (1994), the [Khel Ratna Award](#) (1997), the [Padma Shri](#) (1998), and the [Padma Vibhushan](#) (2008).^{[14][15]} After Tendulkar played his last match in November 2013, the [Prime Minister's Office](#) announced the decision to award him the [Bharat Ratna](#), India's highest civilian award.^{[16][17]} He was the first sportsperson to receive the award and, as of 2024, is the youngest recipient.^{[18][19][20]} Having retired from ODI cricket in 2012,^{[21][22]} he retired from all forms of cricket in November 2013 after playing his [200th Test match](#).^[23] Tendulkar played 664 international cricket matches in total, scoring 34,357 runs.^[24] In 2013, Tendulkar was included in an all-time Test World XI to mark the 150th anniversary of [Wisden Cricketers' Almanack](#), and he was one of only two specialist batsmen of the post–[World War II](#) era, along with [Viv Richards](#), to get featured in the team.^[25]

Tendulkar is regarded as a symbol of national pride in India for his achievements. In 2010, [Time](#) included Tendulkar in its annual [list of the most influential people in the world](#).^[26] Tendulkar was awarded the [Sir Garfield Sobers Trophy](#) for cricketer of the year at the [2010 International Cricket Council \(ICC\) Awards](#).^[27] In 2019, he was inducted into the [ICC Cricket Hall of Fame](#).^[28]

Early life and background

Tendulkar was born at the Nirmal Nursing Home in the [Dadar](#) neighbourhood of [Bombay, Maharashtra](#) (now Mumbai) on 24 April 1973,^{[29][30]} into a [Maharastrian](#) family.^[31] His father, [Ramesh Tendulkar](#), was a [Marathi-language](#) novelist and poet while his mother, Rajni, worked in the insurance industry.^[32] Tendulkar's father named him after his favourite music director, [Sachin Dev Burman](#).^[33] Tendulkar has three older siblings: two half-brothers Nitin and Ajit, and a half-sister Savita. They were his father's children by his first wife, who died after the birth of her third child.^{[34][35]} His brother Ajit played in Bombay's [Kanga Cricket League](#).^[36]

Tendulkar spent his formative years in the Sahitya Sahawas Cooperative Housing Society in [Bandra \(East\)](#). As a young boy, Tendulkar was considered a [bully](#), and he often picked fights with new children in his school.^[37]

As a child, Tendulkar was interested in both [tennis](#) and cricket.^[38] He particularly idolised American player [John McEnroe](#), and emulated his hero by growing his hair long at the age of 7 or 8 years. At this time, Tendulkar also regularly wore tennis wristbands and headbands and carried a [tennis racquet](#) with him as a sign of his love for tennis.^{[39][40][41]}

To help curb his bullying tendencies, his elder brother Ajit introduced Tendulkar to cricket in 1984. Ajit introduced him to cricket coach [Ramakant Achrekar](#) at [Shivaji Park](#) in Dadar. At their first meeting, Tendulkar did not play well. Ajit told Achrekar that he was feeling self-conscious due to the coach observing him, and was not displaying his natural game. Ajit requested the coach to give him another chance at playing, but watch while hiding behind a tree. This time, Tendulkar, apparently unobserved, played much better and was accepted at Achrekar's academy.^[42]^[better source needed]

Achrekar was impressed with Tendulkar's talent and advised him to shift his schooling to Sharadashram Vidyamandir School,^[29] a school in Dadar that had produced many notable cricketers. He made his debut as a cricketer for Sharadashram in late 1984.^[43] Prior to this, Tendulkar had attended the Indian Education Society's New English School in Bandra (East).^[43] He was also coached under the guidance of Achrekar at Shivaji Park in the mornings and evenings.^[44] Tendulkar would practice for hours; if he became exhausted, Achrekar would put a [one-rupee coin](#) on the top of the [stumps](#), and the [bowler](#) who dismissed Tendulkar would get the coin. If Tendulkar completed the session without getting dismissed, the

coach would give him the coin. Tendulkar considers the 13 coins he won among his most prized possessions.^[45] While he was training at Shivaji Park, he moved in with his aunt and uncle, who lived near the park.^[43]

Besides school cricket, Tendulkar also played [club cricket](#). In 1984, at age 11, he debuted in the [Kanga Cricket League](#) while playing for the John Bright Cricket Club.^{[43][46]} Beginning in 1988, he played for the [Cricket Club of India](#).^{[46][47]}

In 1987, at the age of 14, he attended the [MRF Pace Foundation](#) in Madras (now [Chennai](#)) to train as a [fast bowler](#), but the trainer, Australian fast bowler [Dennis Lillee](#), was unimpressed and suggested that Tendulkar focus on his batting instead.^[48] On 20 January 1987, he was a [substitute](#) for [Imran Khan](#)'s team in an exhibition match at [Brabourne Stadium](#) in Bombay.^[49] A couple of months later, former Indian batsman [Sunil Gavaskar](#) gave Tendulkar a pair of his own lightweight [pads](#) and told him to not get disheartened for not receiving the [Bombay Cricket Association](#)'s Best Junior Cricketer Award. Of this experience, Tendulkar later said, "It was the greatest source of encouragement for me".^{[50][51]} Tendulkar served as a [ball boy](#) in the [1987 Cricket World Cup](#) when [India](#) played against [England](#) in the semifinal in Bombay.^{[52][53]}

In 1988, while playing for Sharadashram, Tendulkar and [Vinod Kambli](#) batted in an unbroken 664-run [partnership](#) in a Lord Harris Shield inter-school game against St. Xavier's High School. Tendulkar scored 326 ([not out](#)) in that match and scored over 1,000 runs in the tournament.^[54] This was a record partnership in any form of cricket until 2006, when it was broken by two junior cricketers in [Hyderabad, India](#).^[55]